

Product Requirements Document

Stunion

Document version	0.3
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Status	Draft - pending Phase 0 validation
Take rate	10% (waived for first 15 tutors, first 5 sessions each)
Trust mechanism	Verified transcripts + reviews + escrow + optional intro call

Changes from v0.2

- **Removed video profile requirement.** Trust mechanism now relies on verified transcripts, reviews, and escrow. Reduces MVP build by ~1 week and removes Cloudflare Stream from tech stack.
- **Added 15-min free intro call feature.** Compensates partially for the loss of video preview; tutors who opt in receive a visibility badge.
- **Reframed problem statement.** Problem #3 changed from 'no teaching-quality preview' to 'no payment protection.' Aligns the problem set with what the product actually solves.
- **Locked supply strategy: sisters' network as Tier 1.** Founder's two sisters and their college-graduate friends form the initial vouched-quality tutor pool. Removes cold-outreach risk for first 25 tutors.
- **Added tutor-side promo code.** First 15 tutors receive 0% take rate on their first 5 sessions. Estimated platform revenue lost: ~\$750,000 over 90 days. Treated as customer acquisition cost.
- **Updated revenue forecast.** Months 1-3 are largely promo-period; meaningful revenue starts Month 3-4. \$1k/month still achieved Month 5.
- **Flagged conversion risk.** Without video, parent-to-first-booking conversion may drop from 10% target to 6-8%. Phase 0 must validate.

1. Problem Statement

Korean families at international schools (Chadwick, SFS, KIS, Dwight Seoul, Branksome Hall Asia) collectively spend a portion of Korea's 29.2 trillion won annual private education market on SAT, IB, and AP tutoring [Statistics Korea 2023]. They face three problems no existing platform solves:

1. **No verification layer.** Tutors self-report credentials. Parents have no way to verify that a 'Harvard graduate IB tutor' actually has those credentials before booking.
2. **No price transparency.** Hagwons and individual tutors quote 100,000-300,000 won/hour with no comparable benchmarking.
3. **No payment protection.** Parents pay upfront with no recourse if a tutor underperforms or no-shows. Tutors invoice after sessions and chase payment.

Existing solutions and gaps

Solution	Gap for Stunion's user
Gimgwawi (■■■■), Seoltab (■■■)	Korean curriculum focus; text profiles; no SAT/IB depth; Korean-only UI
Hagwons (offline)	High overhead; group-based; limited 1:1; opaque pricing
Word-of-mouth referrals	Trust-high but supply-constrained; no payment infrastructure
Wyzant, Preply (US)	Not localized to Korea; no IB/Korean university admissions context; limited supply in Korea

2. Target Users

2.1 Demand side (primary)

Persona: Mother of a student at an international school in Seoul/Incheon, household income 150M won+/year, child in grades 9-12 preparing for SAT, IB, or AP.

Job-to-be-done: Find a verified tutor whose credentials match my child's specific test prep needs, with payment protection if it does not work out.

Decision pattern: Researches via KakaoTalk parent groups; asks 3-5 references; books a trial session before committing to a long-term arrangement.

2.2 Supply side (primary)

Persona A (priority): Korean college student or recent graduate (US Top 50, Korean SKY/KAIST/POSTECH), connected to founder's family network, ages 19-25. Looking for 50,000-100,000 won/hour income.

Persona B: Current Chadwick/SFS senior with verified IB scores, ages 17-18, parental consent required.

Persona C (defer to V2): Korean returnees discovered via ■■■■■ ■■ or LinkedIn outreach. Used only after sisters' network is exhausted.

2.3 Out of scope (MVP)

- Korean curriculum (Suneung) tutoring: served by Gimgwawi
- Adult learners
- Group classes
- Test prep companies (B2B sales)

3. Goals and Non-Goals

3.1 Goals (V1)

- Reach 15-20 verified, vouched tutors live within 30 days of MVP launch (sisters' network)
- Reach 25 tutors total within 60 days
- Reach \$1,000 USD monthly platform revenue at 10% take rate within 6 months

- Achieve session repeat rate at or above 50% within 30 days of first booking
- Achieve parent-to-first-booking conversion at or above 8% (revised down from 10% to account for no-video trust friction)

3.2 Non-goals (V1)

- Mobile native app (web responsive only)
- Video tutor profiles (deferred; revisit at V2 based on Phase 0 trust validation data)
- AI diagnostic matching (defer to V2)
- School/hagwon B2B channel
- Background checks via third-party API (manual transcript verification only)
- Live video conferencing infrastructure (use Zoom/Google Meet links)

4. Functional Requirements

4.1 Tutor onboarding

Story: As a tutor, I can create a verified profile and start receiving bookings without recording a video.

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Sign up with email + phone (Korean SMS via Twilio)	P0	OTP delivered in under 30s; account created on verification
Upload university transcript (PDF/image)	P0	File stored encrypted in Supabase storage; reviewed manually within 48h
Upload official test scores (SAT, IB, AP, where applicable)	P0	Same as transcript
Profile photo (head-and-shoulders, clear face)	P0	Required; admin reviews for appropriateness
Write bio (under 500 characters)	P0	Auto-validated for length; manually reviewed for content
Set hourly rate (30,000-200,000 won range)	P0	Field validates range
Select up to 5 subjects from controlled list	P0	Dropdown: SAT Math, SAT R&W, IB HL Math AA/AI, IB HL Econ/Business/Bio/Chem
Toggle: 'Open to 15-min intro call before first booking'	P0	Tutors who opt in get a visibility badge on profile
Sign independent contractor agreement (digital)	P0	Cannot activate without signature; agreement includes 10% platform fee, 3.3% w/o fee
Apply promo code (if assigned)	P0	First 15 tutors receive code 'FOUNDER15' which waives platform fee on first 5 sessions
Profile goes live after admin approval	P0	Manual approval for first 50 tutors; automated rule-based after

Tutor verification states: Pending → Under Review → Verified → Active | Suspended | Rejected

4.2 Parent / student discovery

Story: As a parent, I can find tutors filtered by my child's specific test prep needs and verify their credentials before booking.

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Browse tutors without sign-up	P0	Home page shows tutor grid with photo, first name + last initial, subjects, rate, rating
Filter by subject	P0	Multi-select; results update without page reload
Filter by rate range	P1	Slider 30,000-200,000 won/hour
Filter by language (Korean / English / Both)	P0	Three-state toggle
Filter by 'Open to intro call'	P1	Boolean toggle; helps trust-cautious parents find willing tutors
Sort by rating, rate, response time	P1	Default: rating DESC
View full tutor profile	P0	Profile shows: photo, bio, education + verified credentials display, test scores, subjects
Verified credentials display on profile	P0	Green checkmark badges next to each verified credential (university, SAT score, etc.)
Sign-up required to send booking request or intro call request	P0	Email + phone OTP; minimal form

4.3 Booking and payment (10% take rate)

Story: As a parent, I can book and pay for a tutoring session through the platform with payment held until session completes.

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Submit booking request	P0	Date, time, duration, subject focus, location preference (online/offline); tutor notification
Tutor accepts/declines within 24h	P0	Auto-cancel if no response in 24h
Parent pays full amount upfront via PortOne or TossPayment	P0	Payment held in platform-controlled escrow account
Platform takes 10% transaction fee from gross session amount	P0	Recorded in transactions table; visible to tutor in dashboard at booking time
Promo code 'FOUNDER15' waives platform fee	P0	Applies to first 5 sessions of any tutor with the code; tracked per-tutor; no expiration
3.3% withholding deducted from tutor payout (Korean tax law)	P0	Withholding receipt generated for tutor's tax filing
Tutor payout released within 48h of parent confirmation	P0	Bank transfer via PortOne payout API or manual until volume justifies automation
Refund within 24h of session if parent disputes	P0	Tutor counter-statement collected; manual review by founder for first 100 sessions

Money-flow worked example, standard session at 100,000 won

Step	Standard tutor	Promo-code tutor (first 5 sessions)
Parent pays gross	100,000	100,000
Platform fee	10,000 (10%)	0 (waived)
Tutor gross	90,000	100,000
Withholding tax (3.3% of gross)	2,970	3,300
Tutor net payout	87,030	96,700

Note: 3.3% withholding is paid by the platform to the tax authority on the tutor's behalf (■■■■■ ■■■■■). It is the tutor's tax obligation, not platform revenue. With promo code, platform revenue per session = 0 won; the founder absorbs this as customer acquisition cost.

4.4 Free intro call feature (NEW in v0.3)

Story: As a parent uncertain about a tutor, I can request a 15-minute video call before booking to evaluate fit.

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Tutor opts in during onboarding	P0	Toggle in profile setup; visible badge on profile
Parent requests intro call from profile	P0	Form: preferred times, child's subject focus, what parent wants to discuss
Tutor accepts and provides Zoom/Meet link within 48h	P0	Auto-cancel if no response
Call is 15 minutes max, completely free	P0	Stated in ToS; no platform mediation
After call, parent can book a paid session via standard flow	P0	Standard 10% fee or promo code applies normally
Track intro call → booking conversion rate	P1	Metric for V2 decision on whether to add video

Rationale: Compensates partially for the lack of video tutor profiles. Lower implementation cost than video infrastructure (no Cloudflare Stream needed). If intro call → booking conversion is high, this validates that the trust gap is solvable without video. If low, V2 should add video.

4.5 Disintermediation defense

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Pre-paid session bundles (5 or 10 sessions, 8% discount)	P0	Locks parent financially to platform; bundle credits in dashboard

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
In-platform messaging only until first session paid	P0	Strip phone numbers, KakaoTalk IDs, emails via regex; warn user on attempt
Reviews valid only for on-platform sessions	P0	Tutor's rating freezes if they leave platform
Dispute / refund coverage applies only to on-platform sessions	P0	Visible in ToS and at checkout
Repeat booking discount (3% off after 5 sessions with same tutor)	P1	Encourages parent to keep booking on-platform

Calibration note: At 10% take rate, the per-session financial incentive to disintermediate is 10,000 won on a 100,000 won session. This is meaningful but not catastrophic compared to Tutorspree's 50% rake. **Risk:** Sisters' network tutors have other income options and are most likely to disintermediate. Mitigation depends on platform delivering ongoing convenience value.

4.6 Reviews and trust

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Parent rates session 1-5 stars + optional text after each session	P0	Prompted 24h post-session via email/SMS
Tutor cannot view parent name in review	P1	Reduces retaliation risk
Tutor can respond once to a review	P1	Public response shown below review
Verified Tutor badge	P0	Visible on profile after manual transcript + score review
Top Rated badge	P2	Tutors with rating at or above 4.7 across at least 10 reviews
'Open to Intro Call' badge	P0	Awarded automatically to tutors who toggle on during onboarding

4.7 Admin console (founder)

Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
Tutor approval queue	P0	List view with one-click approve/reject + reason
Transcript / score verification interface	P0	Side-by-side view of credential file and tutor's claimed credentials
Promo code management	P0	Issue, track usage, expire codes; per-tutor session counter
Transaction log	P0	All bookings, fees, payouts, refunds; CSV export for tax filing
Dispute queue	P0	Both parties' statements visible; refund / partial / deny actions
Manual payout trigger (until automated)	P0	Single button per pending payout
Daily metrics dashboard	P1	Active tutors, sessions today, GMV, refund rate, conversion funnel, intro call → b

5. Non-functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	Page load under 2.5s on mobile 4G in Seoul
Languages	Korean (default) + English toggle
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA for tutor profiles
Privacy	PIPA-compliant (Personal Information Protection Act); user data deletion on request within 30 days
Security	All payments via certified Korean PG (PortOne / TossPayments); no card data stored on platform servers; trans
Uptime	99% acceptable at MVP; no SLA promises
Mobile	Responsive web; over 70% of traffic expected mobile

6. Tech Stack

- **Frontend:** Next.js 14 + Tailwind, deployed on Vercel
- **Backend / DB:** Supabase (Postgres, Auth, Storage with encryption, Row-Level Security)
- **Payments:** PortOne (formerly Iamport) primary; TossPayments fallback
- **SMS:** Aligo (Korean SMS gateway)
- **Email:** SendGrid or Resend
- **Analytics:** PostHog (free tier)
- **Error monitoring:** Sentry (free tier)

Removed from v0.2: Cloudflare Stream (no video).

7. Data Model (core tables)

```
users (id, email, phone, role[parent|tutor|admin], created_at, status)
tutor_profiles (user_id, bio, hourly_rate, languages, profile_photo_url,
intro_call_enabled, verification_status)
tutor_subjects (tutor_id, subject_id) -- many-to-many
subjects (id, name, category[SAT|IB|AP|Other])
tutor_credentials (id, tutor_id, type[transcript|test_score], file_url,
verified_at, verified_by_admin_id)
promo_codes (code, tutor_id, free_sessions_remaining, created_at, expires_at)
bookings (id, parent_id, tutor_id, scheduled_at, duration_min, subject_id,
status, gross_amount, fee_amount, payout_amount, promo_code_used)
intro_calls (id, parent_id, tutor_id, requested_at, scheduled_at, completed_at,
converted_to_booking_id)
payments (id, booking_id, pg_transaction_id, amount, status, paid_at)
payouts (id, tutor_id, booking_id, amount, withholding_tax, status, paid_at)
reviews (id, booking_id, parent_id, tutor_id, rating, text, response, created_at)
messages (id, sender_id, recipient_id, booking_id, content, redacted_at)
disputes (id, booking_id, raised_by, reason, resolution, resolved_at)
```

8. Supply Strategy

Stunion's tutor recruitment uses a tiered approach. Tier 1 is the founder's family network (sisters and their college-graduate friends), which provides vouched-quality supply for the first 15-20 tutors. This eliminates cold-outreach risk and credential-verification ambiguity for the launch cohort. Tier 2 expands via Tier 1 referrals. Tier 3 transitions to public recruitment.

Tier	Source	Target count	Timeline	Acquisition cost
Tier 1	Founder's two sisters + their college friends	15	Week 1-3	Promo code (0% fee, 5 sessions)
Tier 2	Tier 1 referrals (■100K bonus per qualified referral)	10	Week 4-8	Referral bonuses
Tier 3	■■■■■ ■■, Chadwick alumni LinkedIn, Naver+ as needed	5	Month 3+	Standard recruitment

8.1 Tier 1 quality criteria

- US Top 50 university OR Korean SKY/KAIST/POSTECH OR US Liberal Arts Top 30
- Subject competency: 7 in HL for IB tutors, 1500+ SAT for SAT tutors, 5 on AP for AP tutors
- Active interest in tutoring as side income (not just willing to do family a favor)
- Vouched by founder's sister as 'good teacher' (not just 'good student')

8.2 Family-pressure mitigation

- 60-day pilot expectation set explicitly with each Tier 1 tutor
- Realistic demand expectation: 'expect 2-5 students if profile is strong'
- Off-ramp: deactivate profile after 30 days with no booking, by mutual agreement
- Quality bar applied uniformly; no exceptions for family connections

9. Launch Plan

Phase	Timeline	Goal
Validation	Weeks 1-2	20 parent + 15 tutor interviews; trust threshold validated; go/no-go decision
Legal setup	Weeks 2-3	■■■■■ (under parent), ■■■■■ ■■, ToS, Privacy Policy
MVP build	Weeks 3-7	All P0 features; closed beta with 5 Tier 1 tutors + 10 parents from network
Soft launch	Weeks 8-11	15-20 Tier 1 tutors live with promo codes; KakaoTalk parent group seeding
Growth phase	Months 3-6	Tier 2 referrals; promo codes start expiring; revenue ramps; reach \$1k/month

10. Success Metrics

Metric	V1 target	Kill threshold
Tier 1 tutors live (Day 30)	15	8
Total verified tutors (Day 60)	25	12
First-month parent sign-ups	60	25
Parent → first booking conversion	8% (revised down from 10%)	3%
Intro call → booking conversion	Track for V2 (no target yet)	n/a
Session repeat rate (30d)	50%	25%
Monthly GMV (Month 6)	13.7M won (~\$10,000)	5M won
Monthly platform revenue (Month 6)	1.37M won (~\$1,000)	500K won
Tutor monthly churn	8% or under	20% or higher

Metric	V1 target	Kill threshold
Refund rate	Under 5%	Over 15%
Promo code burn (Month 1-3 total)	Under 750K won	Over 1.2M won

10.1 Revenue forecast with promo period

Month	Tutors	Sessions	Promo sessions	Paid sessions	Platform revenue
1	15	20	20	0	0
2	20	50	45	5	50K won
3	25	80	30	50	500K won
4	35	110	5	105	1.05M won
5	50	140	0	140	1.4M won (~\$1,020)
6	60	160	0	160	1.6M won (~\$1,170)

Cumulative promo cost over Months 1-3 (worst case): ~10,000 won × 100 promo sessions = 1.0M won (~\$730 USD). Treated as customer acquisition cost. \$1k/month sustained revenue achieved Month 5; cumulative platform revenue over 6 months approximately 4.6M won (~\$3,360 USD).

11. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Trust mechanism without video proves insufficient (Path A fails)	Medium	Critical	Have V0.4 fallback ready: add video back, or pivot to Path B (diagnostic)
Parent registration capacity issues (for now is a minor inconvenience)	High	Critical	Operate under parent's ████████ from day one
Tier 1 tutors disintermediate after promo code expires	Medium	High	Bundle prepayments; messaging filter; convenience value (scheduling)
Sisters' network quality is uneven	Medium	High	Apply quality bar uniformly; sister vouching does not bypass credential
Family pressure if Tier 1 tutors get no bookings	High	Medium	Set 60-day pilot expectation; clear off-ramp
Adult tutor + minor student liability incident	Low	Catastrophic	Mandatory recording for under-18 students; ToS clause; consider insur
Payment dispute / chargeback	Medium	Medium	Clear refund policy; PG-side dispute handling
Naver SEO underperforms vs. expectations	High	Medium	Channel cap policy: max 20% from any single channel
IB grades drop	High	High	Hard 10 hr/week cap; pause growth during exam periods
10% rate seen as too high by tutors after promo	Medium	Medium	Communicate value clearly; tier-down rate for top performers in V2

12. Versioning

- **V1 (this PRD, v0.3):** Korean international school market, 10% take rate, no video, transcripts + reviews + escrow + intro call, promo code for first 15 tutors
- **V2 (post \$1k/month sustained):** Reconsider video addition based on intro call data; AI diagnostic matching; mobile app; tier-down rate for top performers; expansion to Japan/HK international schools
- **V3 (post-Series-A or post-maturity):** B2B hagwon channel, white-label for schools

13. Open Decisions

- Confirm promo code structure: tutor-side only, volume-bounded (5 sessions), capped at 15 tutors? **Assumed yes for v0.3.**
- Confirm domain availability: stunion.com / .co / .kr
- Confirm KIPO + USPTO trademark availability

- Confirm parent will register ██████ under their name
- Phase 0 trust threshold: do at least 4/10 parents say they would book based on transcripts + reviews + escrow alone?

References

- [1] Statistics Korea (KOSTAT), Private Education Expenditure Survey 2023.
- [2] Provided document, Tutorspree post-mortem.
- [3] Provided document, Tutorspree 2026 rebuild plan.
- [4] Korean Income Tax Act, 3.3% withholding for independent contractor service income (████ █████).
- [5] PortOne and TossPayments developer documentation; Korean Electronic Financial Transactions Act compliance.
- [6] Personal Information Protection Act (PIPA, █████████).
- [7] Korean Value-Added Tax Act Article 8, business registration requirement.
- [8] Korean Act on Consumer Protection in Electronic Commerce, █████ █████.
- [9] Korean Civil Act Article 5, capacity of minors to contract.

References [1], [4]-[9] cited from training data and not re-verified for this document. Verify with current Korean tax authority (████), legal counsel, and PG documentation before implementation.